



Windows Update is much less intrusive under Vista



You even get a lot of driver updates via Windows Update

the application's data, close the application, update the file, and then restart the application.

10.6 Diagnostics

Anyone familiar with the diagnostic tools available under a Linux distribution will appreciate the fact that Windows XP obscured the inner workings of the operating system far too much for comfort. Windows Vista exposes several internal system logs and reports through a variety of tools and helps one better understand the working of the OS and thus, predict failures and identifies bottlenecks. Vista can also self-diagnose a number of common problems such as failing hard disks, memory problems, and networking issues. Disk Diagnostics, for example, can detect an impending hard drive failure and trigger data backup. It can also recommend disk replacement if necessary. Similarly, Vista can diagnose memory issues and networking issues: Windows Memory Diagnostics work with Microsoft Online Crash Analysis to detect crashes possibly caused by failing memory, prompting the user to schedule a memory test the next time the computer is started. Vista's built-in diagnostics provides information needed to solve problems that can't be automatically resolved. Whenever Windows Vista detects a potential problem, it raises an event. IT professionals can use these events to monitor, troubleshoot, and automatically set up the system to take corrective steps.